

LBDG

Leadership Bureau for Disclosure Guidance

L E A D E R S H I P & B O A R D
O P E R A T I O N A L T O O L K I T

Governing Through the Unthinkable

Five operational tools for CEOs, Board Chairs, and C-suite executives. The orchestration layer for all other LBDG toolkits. Grounded in fiduciary duty, corporate governance standards, and the nuclear technology analogy framework.

5 tools

CEO · Board · C-Suite

Edition 2025

This toolkit contains:

- ▶ Tool 1 — Board Governance Readiness Scorecard (10 dimensions)
- ▶ Tool 2 — Decision Authority Matrix (who decides what, at what threshold)
- ▶ Tool 3 — Board Briefing Templates by Scenario (A / B1 / B2 / C)
- ▶ Tool 4 — CEO Leadership Guide (how to lead through paradigm shift)
- ▶ Tool 5 — Strategic Review Checklist (decisions that must be revisited)

How this toolkit relates to the others

This is the orchestration layer. It does not replace the HR, Finance, or Communications Toolkits — it activates and coordinates them. The CEO and Board use this toolkit to decide which functions to activate, at what threshold, with what authority. The functional toolkits execute.

TOOL 1 — BOARD GOVERNANCE READINESS SCORECARD

PHASE 1 — Complete at board level. Revisit quarterly.
Owner: Chair + CEO.

 **Score each dimension 1 (unprepared) to 5 (fully ready). Use the gap between today's score and the required level to prioritise board agenda items.**

Governance Dimension	1	2	3	4	5	If score < 3: board agenda item
1 = Not in place 3 = Partial 5 = Fully operational						Circle score → add to agenda
1. Scenario awareness <i>Board has been briefed on A/B1/B2/C framework and signal timeline</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
2. Decision rights defined <i>Authority matrix: who decides what at each threshold, documented and agreed</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
3. Crisis governance protocol <i>Board convening process for unscheduled meetings within 24h defined and tested</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
4. Fiduciary duty briefing <i>Board members understand disclosure obligations (Reg FD, AMF, MAR) in black swan conditions</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
5. Materiality analysis process <i>Documented process for determining what constitutes material information</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
6. Functional toolkit activation <i>Board knows which LBDG toolkits exist and who owns each activation trigger</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
7. Stakeholder strategy <i>Board-level stakeholder communication plan for each scenario</i>	1	2	3	4	5	

8. Succession and continuity <i>Leadership continuity plan if key executives are unavailable during a crisis</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
9. Legal counsel access <i>Outside counsel on retainer with 24h availability for major events</i>	1	2	3	4	5	
10. Board communication channel <i>Secure, tested channel for emergency board communication outside normal meeting cycle</i>	1	2	3	4	5	

Score	Governance Level	Board action required
10–20	CRITICAL GAPS	Schedule emergency board session. Activate legal counsel. Brief all C-suite on LBDG toolkit suite this week.
21–30	PARTIAL	Identify lowest-scored dimensions. Add to next board agenda. Confirm crisis convening protocol.
31–40	ADEQUATE	Schedule tabletop simulation at next board meeting. Confirm legal review of disclosure obligations.
41–50	STRONG BASELINE	Quarterly review only. Ensure incoming board members are briefed on scenario framework.

TOOL 2 — DECISION AUTHORITY MATRIX

PHASES 1 AND 2 — Define in advance. Activate at J0.
Removes ambiguity when speed matters most.

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The most dangerous governance failure in a crisis is ambiguity about who can decide what. Pre-defining authority is the difference between a 1-hour response and a 72-hour committee meeting. Complete this matrix before any announcement.

2.1 — Crisis Decision Authority

Decision	CEO alone	CEO + CFO	Full Board	Time limit
Activate crisis protocol (all toolkits)	● YES			H+1
Freeze non-essential capital (< 10% budget)	● YES			H+1
Freeze non-essential capital (> 10% budget)		● YES		H+4
Draw contingency credit line		● YES		H+12
Issue public statement / press release			● YES	H+4
Amend periodic securities filings			● YES	H+24
Announce major M&A or disposal			● YES	Board call
Activate leadership succession plan			● YES	H+24
Brief regulators on material information		● YES		H+12
External counsel engagement (new mandate)	● YES			H+2
Change in executive headcount (> 5%)			● YES	Board call
Internal emergency board	● YES			H+4

convening				
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2.2 — Toolkit Activation Authority

Toolkit	Activation trigger	Activation authority	Escalation to board
HR Operational Toolkit	Any scenario A, B1, B2, or C confirmed	CHRO + CEO	Within 24h
Finance Operational Toolkit	Any scenario + DVI > 5 or equity drawdown > 5%	CFO + CEO	Within 12h
Communications Toolkit	Any scenario + first media contact received	CCO + CEO	Within 4h
Leadership & Board Toolkit (this)	Any scenario A, B1, B2, or C confirmed	CEO + Chair	Immediate
External legal counsel brief	Any material information threshold crossed	CEO + General Counsel	Within 12h

TOOL 3 — BOARD BRIEFING TEMPLATES

PHASE 2 — Activate at J0. One template per scenario. Legal sign-off required before distribution.

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Fiduciary principle: In black swan conditions, the board's obligation is to process uncertainty rationally, document decisions with dates and attendees, and avoid selective disclosure. Every board briefing in a crisis must be formally minuted, however brief. "We discussed it informally" is not a governance record.

SCENARIO A — Soft Disclosure: Government Acknowledgment Only

CONFIDENTIAL BOARD BRIEFING — [Date] — [Time]

Scenario Classification: A — Soft Disclosure | Prepared by: [CEO / CCO] | Board members present: [list]

WHAT HAPPENED (facts only):

[Government / agency] has officially acknowledged [describe factual content in one sentence]. Source: [official source]. No technology revelation. No crash retrieval confirmation. No contact confirmation.

IMMEDIATE IMPACT ASSESSMENT:

Financial: Moderate short-term volatility expected. No structural sector disruption implied. Monitor equity position daily.

Operational: No immediate operational impact. Business continuity status: NORMAL. HR protocol: MONITORING.

Reputational: Low direct risk. Communications holding statement issued [Y/N]. Next media update: [time].

DECISIONS REQUIRED FROM BOARD:

- ☐ Confirm: CEO authorized to manage under standard crisis protocol (no additional board approvals required at this stage)
- ☐ Confirm: Communications holding statement approved for release
- ☐ Confirm: Legal counsel engagement authorized

NEXT BOARD UPDATE: [Date/Time] | DOCUMENTED BY: [Name, Date, Time]

SCENARIO B1 — Crash Retrieval Confirmed: No Technology Mastered

CONFIDENTIAL BOARD BRIEFING — [Date] — [Time]

Scenario Classification: B1 — Crash Retrieval Confirmed | Prepared by: [CEO / CFO] | Board members present: [list]

WHAT HAPPENED (facts only):

[Source] has confirmed existence of crash retrieval and analysis programs involving non-human craft. No commercializable technology announced. No reverse engineering results disclosed. This is a confirmation of program existence, not a technology transfer event.

IMPACT ASSESSMENT:

Financial: Market drawdown 5-12% expected. No structural sector disruption. Defense sector positive. CRITICAL: Any defense contractor exposure in portfolio must be reviewed for legacy program legal risk (see Finance Toolkit Tool 5). Activate Finance Toolkit immediately.

Legal: If organization has defense contractor relationships or investments, initiate outside counsel review within 24h. Potential Class Action and False Claims Act exposure for contractors in legacy programs.

Operational: HR Toolkit activated. Communications Toolkit activated. Monitor employee sentiment daily.

DECISIONS REQUIRED FROM BOARD:

- ☐ Confirm: Finance Toolkit activated (CFO + CEO)
- ☐ Confirm: HR Toolkit activated (CHRO + CEO)
- ☐ Confirm: Outside counsel engaged for defense contractor exposure review
- ☐ Confirm: Materiality analysis initiated — is this information material to our investors? (Legal + CFO)

NEXT BOARD UPDATE: [Date/Time] — within 24 hours | **DOCUMENTED BY:** [Name, Date, Time]

SCENARIO B2 — Partial Reverse Engineering Confirmed (Nuclear Analogy Applies)

CONFIDENTIAL BOARD BRIEFING — [Date] — [Time]

Scenario Classification: B2 — Partial Reverse Engineering | Nuclear Analogy Active | Board members present: [list]

FRAMEWORK NOTE — Nuclear Analogy:

Technology confirmed but NOT commercialized. Apply nuclear precedent: Manhattan Project (1945) to commercial reactor (1960) = 15-20 years. Energy sector disruption is generational, not quarterly. Do not overreact on energy exposure today. The immediate risk is legal and geopolitical, not technological displacement.

IMPACT ASSESSMENT:

Financial: Drawdown 8-18% expected. Defense circle-of-trust: STRONG POSITIVE. Defense legacy programs: SEVERE LEGAL RISK. Energy sector: no immediate structural impact (20-30y horizon). Activate reverse stress test immediately.

Legal: MAXIMUM PRIORITY. False Claims Act, IP ownership, shareholder disclosure, amnesty dynamics. Outside counsel within 2 hours if any defense contractor exposure exists. Do not discuss specific company names without legal counsel present.

Strategic: This is a 12-18 month repricing event. Begin strategic review of long-term positioning relative to scenario B2 sector map.

DECISIONS REQUIRED FROM BOARD — WITHIN 12 HOURS:

- ☐ **URGENT: Outside counsel engaged (legal risk assessment)**
- ☐ Finance Toolkit activated — all 5 tools, starting with Tool 1 (Sector Exposure Audit)
- ☐ Confirm: Materiality analysis completed and documented by legal counsel
- ☐ Authorize: Strategic review mandate for next 90 days

NEXT BOARD UPDATE: Within 12 hours | **DOCUMENTED BY:** [Name, Date, Time]

SCENARIO C — Full Confirmation of Ongoing Contact (Maximum Disruption)

CONFIDENTIAL BOARD BRIEFING — [Date] — [Time]

Scenario Classification: C — Active Contact Confirmed | MAXIMUM PROTOCOL | Board members present: [list]

IMMEDIATE CEO STATEMENT TO BOARD:

"Our first priority is organizational continuity and the welfare of our people. Our second priority is legal protection. Our third priority is stakeholder communication. We are activating all LBDG protocols simultaneously. No public statement without board approval."

IMPACT ASSESSMENT — SCENARIO C IS MAXIMUM DISRUPTION:

Financial: 15-30% market drawdown. Cyclical, financials, travel SEVERELY impacted. Activate contingency funding immediately. Run liquidity stress test today.

Operational: Prepare for potential staff unavailability, supply chain disruption, office closure scenarios. Activate BCP.

Legal: Every disclosure obligation activated simultaneously. Simultaneous press release, regulatory filing, investor communication required. No selective disclosure under any circumstances.

NON-NEGOTIABLE IMMEDIATE ACTIONS — ALL AUTHORIZED BY BOARD NOW:

- ☐ ALL four LBDG toolkits activated simultaneously
- ☐ Outside counsel on-site or on call immediately
- ☐ Contingency funding lines drawn
- ☐ Board convenes daily until situation stabilizes
- ☐ No executive makes public statements without board approval

NEXT BOARD MEETING: Within 24 hours. Then daily. | DOCUMENTED BY: [Name, Date, Time]

TOOL 4 — CEO LEADERSHIP GUIDE

ALL PHASES — For CEOs only. How to lead when the ground shifts beneath everyone.

KEY

Col. Karl Nell's framework (US Army, UAP Task Force): The difference between controlled and catastrophic disclosure is the quality of institutional response. Your leadership in the first 72 hours is the largest single variable in determining which one your organization experiences.

4.1 — The First Hour: What You Must Do Before Anything Else

Do ne	Priority	Action	Time
YOUR FIRST 15 MINUTES			
☐	CEO	Breathe. Your team will mirror your emotional state. Calm is contagious — in both directions.	Now
☐	CEO	Call the Chair. Two sentences: what happened, you are activating protocol. Nothing more until you have facts.	Minute 5
☐	CEO	Do NOT check social media, news alerts, or public sentiment. That is someone else's job for the next 30 minutes.	Minute 5
☐	CEO	Confirm which LBDG scenario (A / B1 / B2 / C) this is using Tool 2 of the Finance Toolkit.	Minute 10
☐	CEO	Text your direct reports: "Crisis protocol activated. Call at [time]. Standby." That is the entire message.	Minute 15
H + 1 TO H + 4 — COMMAND			
☐	CEO	Convene crisis team (CFO, CHRO, CCO, GC). 20 minutes maximum. Scenario confirmed, toolkits assigned, owners named.	H+1
☐	CEO	Delegate monitoring explicitly. You do not monitor — you decide. Assign one person per domain: finance, HR, comms, legal.	H+1
☐	CEO	Review and approve holding statement. One person	H+2

		writes, you approve or reject. Do not write it yourself.	
☐	CEO	Brief your board chair. Call, not text. Five minutes: scenario, actions taken, first board briefing time.	H+2
☐	CEO	Confirm your communication cadence: when you will update the crisis team, the board, and all staff.	H+4
H + 24 TO J + 7 — LEADERSHIP PRESENCE			
☐	CEO	Walk the floor or record a video message for staff. Your presence matters more than any email.	H+24
☐	CEO	One-on-one calls with your direct reports. Not to get updates — to check on them as people.	Daily
☐	CEO	Second all-staff communication: "Here is what we now know. Here is what we still do not know. Here is what we are doing."	J+3
☐	CEO	Public statement if appropriate: calm, factual, human. No hedging, no corporate-speak.	J+5 to J+7

4.2 — What to Say to Your Executive Team

Your executive team needs three things from you: clarity on what is happening, confidence in the process, and permission to not have all the answers. Use this script in the first crisis team meeting.

Opening (say this in the first 60 seconds):

"Here is what we know for certain: [one factual sentence about the official announcement]. Here is what we do not know yet: [one sentence on what is uncertain]. Here is what we are doing: we are following our protocol. Our job right now is not to have all the answers — it is to make sure our people feel led."

Assign roles (say this clearly):

"[CFO]: you own financial monitoring and the Finance Toolkit. [CHRO]: you own people and HR Toolkit. [CCO]: you own all external and internal comms. [GC]: you own legal review. I own the board, the strategic decisions, and the public face. We report to each other every four hours. No freelancing on communications."

Close with this:

"I do not know exactly where this goes. Neither do you. Neither does anyone. What I know is that we have prepared for this, we have good people in this room, and we are going to get through it. Let's go."

4.3 — What Leaders Do Wrong in Paradigm-Shifting Crises

Common failure	What to do instead
Waiting for certainty before communicating	Communicate uncertainty explicitly. "We don't know yet" is information. Silence creates speculation.
Trying to assess the content of the announcement personally	Delegate content monitoring. Your job is organizational response, not disclosure analysis.
Over-communicating speculation as fact	Every external statement must contain only confirmed facts. Label everything else as pending assessment.
Protecting the team from the reality	Respect your team's intelligence. Give them the facts and the framework, not a sanitized version.
Heroic solo decision-making	Follow the decision authority matrix. Document everything. Unilateral decisions in a crisis create legal exposure.
Confusing urgency with panic	Speed matters. Panic destroys it. The protocol gives you speed without panic.

TOOL 5 — STRATEGIC REVIEW CHECKLIST

PHASE 3 — Begin within 30 days of any Scenario B1, B2, or C event. Owner: CEO + Board Strategy Committee.

KEY

A paradigm-shifting announcement does not just require a crisis response. It requires a strategic review. The decisions you made before the announcement may no longer be valid. This checklist identifies what to re-examine and in what order.

Strategic question to re-examine		Applicable scenario	Timeline
FINANCIAL STRATEGY			
☐	Does our 3-year financial plan remain valid under the active scenario?	B1 / B2 / C	Day 1-30
☐	Do our investment portfolio assumptions reflect the new sector risk map?	B1 / B2 / C	Day 1-30
☐	Has our cost of capital changed given market conditions?	B2 / C	Day 1-14
☐	Do we have sufficient liquidity for a 12-month extended uncertainty period?	All	Day 1-7
PEOPLE STRATEGY			
☐	Do we have the right leadership capabilities for post-disclosure uncertainty?	All	Day 30-60
☐	Does our talent strategy account for potential attrition in destabilized sectors?	B2 / C	Day 30-60
☐	Is our EAP infrastructure scaled for sustained psychological demand?	All	Day 1-30
☐	Do our succession plans account for scenarios where key leaders are unavailable?	C	Day 1-14
COMPETITIVE AND MARKET STRATEGY			
☐	Do our growth assumptions hold in a	B1 / B2 / C	Day 30-90

	post-disclosure macro environment?		
☐	Are any of our core markets structurally threatened by the active scenario?	B2 / C	Day 30-60
☐	Do our existing partnerships and JVs remain strategically aligned?	B2 / C	Day 60-90
☐	Are there new market opportunities created by the disclosure event?	B2 / C	Day 60-90

GOVERNANCE AND LEGAL

☐	Do our current securities filings adequately disclose this risk category?	All	Day 1-7
☐	Do we need to amend risk factors in our annual report / 10-K?	B1 / B2 / C	Day 7-30
☐	Have we formally documented all board decisions taken since J0?	All	Day 1
☐	Is our D&O insurance coverage adequate for black swan governance scenarios?	B2 / C	Day 30-60

ANALOGY

Nuclear analogy applied to strategic review: In 1945, organizations in transportation, energy, and defence that began repositioning within 6 months of Hiroshima were better placed for the structural changes of the next decade. Those that assumed normalcy would return in weeks made decisions they could not reverse. The strategic review is not optional. It is a board-level fiduciary obligation.

REFERENCE FRAMEWORK

Framework / Source	Applied in this toolkit
Col. Karl Nell (US Army ret., 2023)	Controlled vs catastrophic disclosure framework — CEO leadership imperative (Tool 4)
Deloitte AG 2026 GPMESII Report	NHI as credible Black Swan — board briefing context (Tool 3)
ISO 31000 / COSO ERM	Risk as "effect of uncertainty on objectives" — governance framework (Tools 1, 2)
SEC Regulation FD / AMF / UK MAR	Simultaneous disclosure obligations — authority matrix and briefing templates (Tools 2, 3)
LBDG Nuclear Analogy Framework	Scenario B2 strategic review — 15-30y commercialization timeline (Tools 3, 5)
LBDG Finance Toolkit	Sector exposure, trigger thresholds, compliance — referenced and activated (Tools 2, 3)
LBDG HR Toolkit	People and communication activation — referenced and coordinated (Tools 2, 4)
LBDG Communications Toolkit	Stakeholder cascade and media response — referenced and coordinated (Tools 2, 4)

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